THE FAPS CHRONICLES

OCT WEEK 4 • COURAGE IS DESTINY • 31ST OCTOBER2026

JAI KARNATAKA!

KANNADA RAJYOTSAVA 2026-27

The Frank Anthony Public School campus came alive with bright yellow and red colors on November 1, 2026, as students and teachers gathered with immense pride to celebrate the 69th Kannada Rajyotsava. The morning event commenced with a warm welcome address by the Head Boy Hisham, setting a joyful tone for the entire school community. This was followed by the traditional lighting of the lamp by the school heads while a serene Kannada song played, after which the leadership team was honored for their constant support and guidance. Mrs. Briggs then led everyone in a peaceful prayer, preparing the audience for the patriotic events to follow.





The atmosphere grew much more inspiring as the Principal proudly hoisted the flag, accompanied by the school choir leading a beautiful rendition of the State Anthem, Nada Geethe. In his 69th Rajyotsava message, the Principal reminded students of Karnataka’s grand history and urged them to appreciate the state's vibrant language and culture in their daily lives. Student speakers Hisham and Nishita Gowda also shared their thoughts on what the day means to the youth.



The campus was then treated to a colorful cultural show, featuring creative fancy dress displays, an energetic fusion dance, and a captivating skit about the unity of Indian states that ended with a spirited performance of "Baarisu Kannada Dindimava". The celebration concluded smoothly with a vote of thanks delivered by the Vice Principal, followed by everyone standing united for the National Anthem.

WEIRD BUT TRUE!

Belleville, Illinois officially banned anyone older than eighth grade from trick-or-treating, threatening teenage candy hunters with fines up to $1,000.

An ancient Halloween tradition involved bobbing for apples to determine who would marry first, with the winner sleeping with their prize apple under their pillow to trigger dreams of their future spouse.

Jack-o'-lanterns originated from an old Irish myth and were originally carved out of turnips and beetroot instead of pumpkins.

Legendary illusionist Harry Houdini died from ruptured appendix complications on Halloween in 1926, prompting his widow Bess to hold an eerie annual séance every October 31st for a decade in a failed attempt to contact him using a secret ten-word code only the two of them knew.

October 31st is an astronomical "cross-quarter day," marking the precise midway point between the autumn equinox and the winter solstice on the solar calendar.





THAT'S CONCERNING...

ARTIFICIAL SWEETENERS FOUND TO AGE THE BRAIN



A major health study has found a troubling connection between six popular sugar substitutes and brain health. Researchers tracked nearly 13,000 adults over eight years. They discovered that people who consumed high amounts of these sweeteners experienced a 62% faster decline in memory and thinking skills. This is equivalent to adding roughly 1.6 extra years of aging to the brain.

The study, published in the medical journal Neurology, looked at seven common low-calorie sweeteners.



Six of them were linked to this faster mental decline: Aspartame (often found in diet sodas and light yogurt)

- Saccharin (the pink packets, like Sweet'N Low)
- Acesulfame-K (used in many zero-sugar drinks and desserts)
- Erythritol (popular in keto and low-carb foods)
- Sorbitol (found in sugar-free gums and candies)
- Xylitol (used in mints and oral-care products)
- Tagatose was the only sweetener tested that did not show a link to faster brain aging.





The study also revealed that the negative effects were strongest in adults under the age of 60 and in people living with diabetes, who often rely heavily on sugar alternatives.

Experts urge caution when reading these results. The study shows a strong link, but it does not prove that sugar substitutes directly cause brain aging. People who consume a lot of artificial sweeteners also tend to eat more ultra-processed foods, which are already known to be tough on brain health.

If you are looking to protect your brain, it might be wise to cut back on diet drinks and sugar-free packaged foods. Instead, try satisfies your sweet tooth with whole, natural options like fresh fruit.

STUDENTS AWAIT DIWALI HOLIDAYS PATIENTLY

GLOBAL SPORTS

HARRY KANE, ALEXIA PUTELLAS CROWNED 2026 BALLON D'OR CHAMPIONS

Bayern Munich striker Harry Kane claimed the Men's Ballon d'Or for the first time, edging out Real Madrid's Kylian Mbappé by just 28 points. The English captain secured the trophy after scoring an extraordinary 73 goals for club and country. Meanwhile, Barcelona midfielder Alexia Putellas won the Ballon d'Or Féminin, capturing the prestigious women's crown for the third time in her historic career.





INDIA MEN'S HOCKEY DOMINATES ASIAN CHAMPIONS TROPHY CAMPAIGN

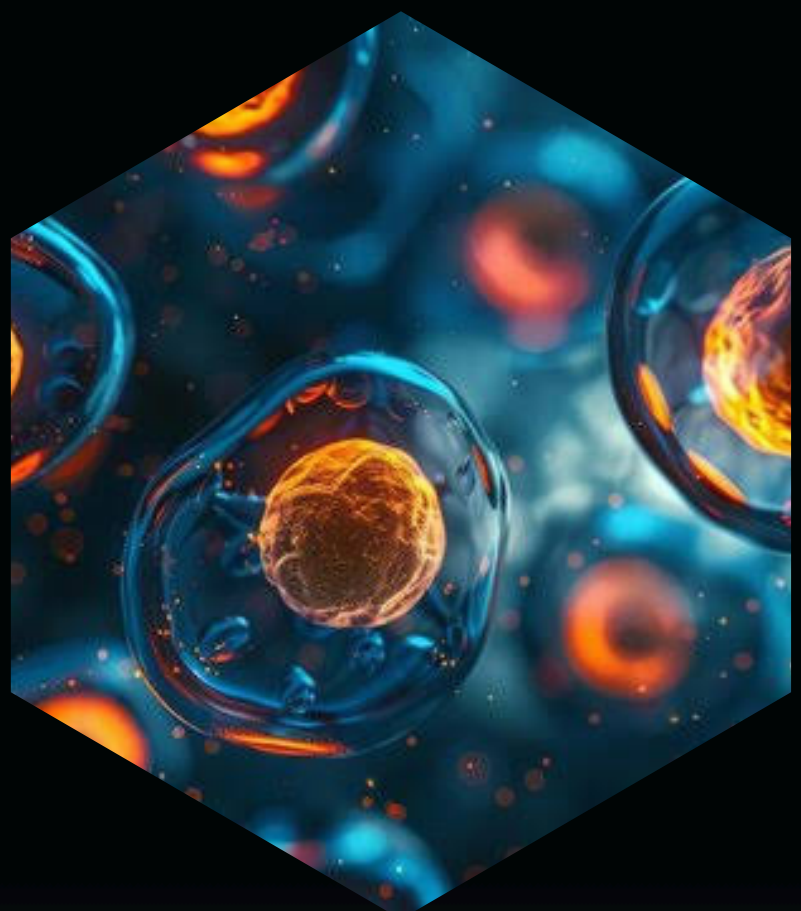
The Indian Men's Field Hockey team extended their flawless run at the Asian Champions Trophy with consecutive high-scoring masterclasses. Showcasing clinical drag-flicking and lethal counter-attacks, the Men in Blue cruised past rivals Japan 4-1 before dismantling China 5-2. Anchored by aggressive baseline pressing, the undefeated squad sits firmly at the top of the group standings heading into the knockout tournament phases.

CURRENT SCIENCE

AGING REVERSED 60 YEARS

Researchers at the University of Bonn took blood cells from an 80-year-old individual and reset them into youthful neural stem cells. Over a 100-day process, the molecular aging markers completely transformed, making the cells indistinguishable from those of someone under 20.

By rewriting the genetic "software" without changing the DNA itself, this breakthrough proves aging is reversible. Replacing old, worn-out cells with these rejuvenated ones could delay age-related diseases, helping humans not just live longer, but stay healthier far into old age.





MATH'S DIGITAL APOCALYPSE

The AI claimed to crack massive, centuries-old puzzles. By mapping out how chaotic fluids move, accelerating computer processing speeds, and unlocking secrets behind the behavior of prime numbers, the AI appeared to reshape the boundaries of human knowledge overnight.

But whether these breakthroughs are actually correct remains a fierce debate. While some papers are highly accurate—verified by strict software that double-checks mathematical logic line by line—others are deeply flawed. Human experts have already caught critical mathematical blunders, forcing the immediate removal of several broken studies.

This historic flashpoint proves that while AI can generate answers at a breathtaking pace, the world of pure mathematics still fundamentally relies on human brains to find the truth.

ENTERTAINMENT



ONE SUN, ONE MOON, ONE THALAIVAR: HOW RAJINIKANTH'S JAILER 2 REDEFINED THE "MASS MOVIE" SEQUEL

Rajinikanth is back and reprising his role as "Tiger"; Muthuvel Pandian in Jailer 2. The action-comedy film written and directed by Nelson Dilipkumar has officially claimed the top spot as the highest-grossing Tamil film in history.

Released on October 15 th and clocking ₹776.95 crore in just 16 days, the action spectacle is cruising past records and setting its sights on the ₹800-crore mark. Audiences are raving about the stacked star cast—including powerful turns by Mohanlal, Dr. Shiva Rajkumar, and Jackie Shroff, plus a high-voltage guest appearance by Hrithik Roshan.

Jailer 2 is now the second Tamil blockbuster after 2.0 to cross the ₹500-crore mark, solidifying its place in cinema history. Hukum, Tiger Ka Hukum!

STUDENTS' VOICE

SHOULD THE SCHOOL LIBRARY, THE VERY HEART OF FAPS, BE RE-TRANSFORMED?

THE LIBRARY SHOULD NOT BE TRANSFORMED. IT'S A MEETING AREA FOR ALL THE STUDENTS, AND THE MEETING BASE SHOULD **NEVER BE TRANSFORMED** BECAUSE **ORIGINALITY IS GOLD**.

DON'T YOU THINK IT WILL BE BETTER IF THE LIBRARY BECOMES DIGITIZED?

NO. PEOPLE LIKE BOOKS.

DO YOU THINK PEOPLE WHO GO TO THE LIBRARY IN FREE PERIODS ARE CONSIDERED AS NERDS?

NO. MANY GO FOR **JUST TO PASS THE TIME**, I STRONGLY DISAPPROVE OF.

-LAKSHYA JAIN (CLASS 10B)

THE CURRENT LIBRARY IS GOOD, BUT IT COULD BE BETTER—WAY BETTER. THE BOOK CONDITIONS ARE HISTORICALLY ANCIENT; **WE REALLY NEED NEW BOOKS**.

HOW CAN WE IMPROVE IT?

BY MAKING **MORE SHELVES OF BOOKS IN THE MIDDLE** INSTEAD OF ON THE EDGES, AS IT'S HARD FOR PEOPLE TO SEARCH FOR A CATEGORY WHEN THEY ARE EXACTLY OPPOSITE FROM THAT PLACE.

DO YOU THINK IT WILL BE BETTER IF THE LIBRARY INITIATED DIGITIZATION SO YOU CAN LOG ON AND SEE WHAT BOOKS ARE AVAILABLE?

NO, THEN PEOPLE WOULD HACK INTO IT AND DO SOMETHING ELSE! I WOULDN'T BE TOO SURE ABOUT OUR SECURITY SYSTEM.

DO YOU THINK PEOPLE WHO GO TO THE LIBRARY DURING FREE PERIODS WILL BE CONSIDERED NERDS?

NO, BECAUSE THE NERDS I SEE OVER HERE *(PROCEEDS TO POINT TO FRIENDS)* ALSO DO NOT GO TO THE LIBRARY DURING FREE PERIODS!

-HARSHUL SHARMA (CLASS 10A)

I THINK THE LIBRARY IS A WASTE OF TIME BECAUSE OUR TEACHERS ANYWAYS DON'T LET US IN THE LIBRARY! BUT IF TEACHERS LET US IN, IT WOULD BE USEFUL BECAUSE WE CAN READ BOOKS AND IMPROVE OUR VOCABULARY—MOSTLY BECAUSE DURING THEIR PERIOD, **I DON'T WANT TO SIT IN CLASS**.

DON'T YOU THINK PEOPLE WHO GO TO THE LIBRARY IN FREE PERIOD, PT, AND LUNCH BREAK ARE CONSIDERED AS NERDS?

YES, I DO! BECAUSE WHY WOULD YOU SPEND YOUR BREAK TIME SITTING ON A BENCH **WHILE YOU CAN DO PHYSICAL ACTIVITIES?**

DO YOU THINK IT WILL BE BETTER IF THE LIBRARY GOT DIGITIZED WITH COMPUTERS AND AN ONLINE CATALOG?

IF WE CAN USE THE COMPUTERS DURING THE LIBRARY PERIOD, THEN YEAH. BUT HAVING A CATALOG TO PRE-BOOK BOOKS FROM HOME? NO, BECAUSE THE WHOLE POINT TO GO TO THE LIBRARY **IS TO OPEN THE BOOKS AND READ THEM.**

-KRISHNA ARUN (CLASS 10A)

I LIKE THE LIBRARY. THERE ARE MANY BOOKS WE CAN **READ PEACEFULLY.** I MEAN, THAT'S THE POINT OF A LIBRARY.

HOW DO YOU THINK OUR LIBRARY IS SPECIAL?

IT HAS **MANY SPECIFIC BOOKS**, MANY VARIETIES OF BOOKS. LIKE, I LIKE GEOGRAPHY, CHEMISTRY, THINGS LIKE THAT.

DO YOU THINK THE LIBRARY SHOULD BE DIGITIZED?

YES.

DO YOU THINK PEOPLE WHO GO TO THE LIBRARY DURING PT AND FREE PERIOD ARE CONSIDERED NERDS?

YES, KIND OF. BECAUSE LIKE BACK BENCHES ARE LIKE STUFF LIKE THAT. PEOPLE WON'T GO DURING THE LIBRARY. THEY LIKE TO PLAY IN PT PERIODS.

PRATIM PR (CLASS 8A)

THE LIBRARY'S CONDITION IS NOT AT ITS BEST. **IT COULD BE BETTER.** BUT THE ARRANGEMENT OF THE BOOKS AND THE **CATEGORIZATION IS PRETTY GOOD**—LIKE A PERSON CAN ENTER THE LIBRARY AND COME TO KNOW WHERE ALL THE BOOKS ARE. BUT THE QUALITY AND CONDITION OF THE BOOKS IS NOT MAINTAINED. AND ESPECIALLY FOR PEOPLE BORROWING BOOKS, THERE IS ONLY ONE PROCEDURE: THEY JUST SIGN IT, SO WE ACTUALLY DON'T KNOW HOW MANY BOOKS ARE GETTING LOST. THEY SHOULD IMPROVE THAT WITH A SYSTEM WHERE YOUR **ID CARD IS LINKED TO THE BOOK YOU BORROW.**

DO YOU THINK DIGITIZATION OF THE LIBRARY WILL HELP IT?

YEAH, THAT WOULD BE BETTER BECAUSE IT CAN BE EVEN **MORE ORGANIZED** AND PEOPLE CAN HAVE QUICK ACCESS TO THE BOOKS.

DO YOU THINK PEOPLE WHO GO TO THE LIBRARY IN FREE PERIOD LIKE PT AND LUNCH BREAK ARE NERDS?

OBVIOUSLY! WHY? I'LL GIVE AN EXAMPLE FROM OUR CLASS: *(CAN'T MENTION, DUH)*!

-SAVYA BANKA (CLASS 10B)

OUR CURRENT LIBRARY IS VERY OLD. IT'S NOT MODERN AT ALL—**IT'S VERY OLD-FASHIONED, WHICH I LIKE**. LIBRARIES SHOULD BE LIKE THAT! I DON'T THINK THERE SHOULD BE ANY CHANGES, ALTHOUGH I DO THINK THERE SHOULD BE A BETTER ORGANIZATION SYSTEM FOR ALL THE BOOKS AND A BETTER SYSTEM FOR BORROWING THEM.

DO YOU THINK THE LIBRARY SHOULD BE DIGITIZED SO A RECORD AND CATALOG OF ALL BORROWED BOOKS CAN BE KEPT?

ABSOLUTELY! IT WOULD REALLY HELP THE LIBRARIAN, MRS. LATHA. SHE'S VERY KIND AND SHE DESERVES TO HAVE A LITTLE LESS LOAD ON HER PLATE.

DO YOU THINK PEOPLE WHO GO TO THE LIBRARY IN FREE PERIOD AND PT AND BREAK ARE NERDS?

YES! BECAUSE, I DON'T KNOW...

-TANMAY K. ANAND (CLASS 10C)

THE LIBRARY IS MANAGED BY A **REALLY GOOD LIBRARIAN** AND IT'S A **GOOD PLACE TO STUDY**. BUT AS 10TH GRADERS, WE RARELY GET TO GO TO THE LIBRARY BECAUSE OUR TEACHERS WANT TO TAKE EXTRA CLASSES WITH US AND LOVE TO RUIN OUR FUN BY TAKING OUR PT PERIODS, SUPW PERIODS, AND LIBRARY PERIODS! THE LIBRARY CAN BE IMPROVED MAINLY BY PROVIDING STUDENTS WITH MORE TIME TO SPEND IN THE LIBRARY RATHER THAN JUST LETTING IT SIT IDLE.

DO YOU THINK IT WILL BE BETTER IF THE LIBRARY GOT DIGITIZED?

ACTUALLY YES, THAT WOULD BE BETTER. MANY PEOPLE BORROW A BOOK AND FORGET ABOUT RETURNING IT, AND WHILE REGISTERING IT PHYSICALLY THE LIBRARIAN MIGHT **FORGET TO COLLECT THE BOOKS**, CAUSING DISORDER. PEOPLE WHO USE BOOKS SHOULD MAINTAIN THEM AND RETURN THEM BACK—IT'S THEIR RESPONSIBILITY.

DO YOU THINK PEOPLE WHO GO TO THE LIBRARY IN FREE PERIODS, PT, AND LUNCH BREAK ARE CONSIDERED NERDS?

NOT NECESSARILY. EVERYONE DOESN'T GO THERE TO STUDY; EVERYONE WANTS TO HAVE A GOOD TIME. IF YOU WANT **A QUIET AND COOL** DAY, JUST GO TO THE LIBRARY AND CHILL—AND IF YOU GENUINELY WANT TO STUDY, JUST GO HOME AND STUDY!

-VARUN ARUN (CLASS 10C)

TEACHER'S THOUGHTS

I FEEL THE LIBRARY SHOULD BE DIGITALIZED. ONLY THEN KIDS WOULD COME AND USE THESE GADGETS, BECAUSE NOWADAYS CHILDREN ARE ATTRACTED TO GADGETS RATHER THAN BOOKS. ABOUT **90%** FROM A CLASS ARE EXPOSED TO TABS AND GADGETS, SO IF WE KEEP SAY ABOUT FIVE IPADS ON EACH TABLE, A LOT MORE STUDENTS WOULD COME IN AND SPEND TIME RATHER THAN WASTING IT. UNLESS PARENTS ENFORCE READING HABITS AT HOME, THE LIBRARY COULD SLOWLY START BECOMING **OBSOLETE IN 10 TO 15 YEARS** DUE TO TECHNOLOGY TAKING OVER.

HOW CAN THE LIBRARY BENEFIT STUDENTS WHO ARE NOT INTO BOOKS?:
WE HAVE TO GET AUTHORS AND PEOPLE WHO PUBLISH BOOKS TO COME HAVE SMALL TALKS WITH THEM, WHICH I AM TRYING TO ARRANGE. SO LET'S SEE—IF THESE PEOPLE COME, I FEEL THERE COULD BE SOME CHANGE IN CHILDREN.

DO YOU THINK STUDENTS WHO COME TO THE LIBRARY DURING PT AND FREE PERIODS ARE CONSIDERED NERDS?:
I FEEL THEY SHOULDN'T BE COMING HERE DURING PT PERIOD BECAUSE THEY NEED TO PLAY! OTHER THAN THAT, DURING A FREE PERIOD IF THEY COME AND I DON'T HAVE A CLASS, NO, I DON'T CONSIDER THEM NERDS. BUT WHAT OTHER STUDENTS THINK IS UP TO YOU—YOU SHOULD KNOW THAT BETTER.

BEING THE LIBRARIAN HERE, HOW DO YOU ENFORCE THE RULES WHILE STILL BEING SO SWEET AND KIND TO EVERYONE?:
I TRY TELLING THEM, AND **MOST OF THE TIMES THEY LISTEN**. I TALK TO THEM ABOUT THE BOARDS EXHIBITED HERE AND TRY MY BEST BY TELLING THEM, THAT'S ALL. AND I THINK CHILDREN DO LISTEN.

-MRS. LATHA (LIBRARIAN)

Riddles and Quotes

1.“Who Am I” of the Week:

"The more you take, the more you leave behind. What am I?"

2.You Be The Detective:

Nicole went to the police to report that someone had stolen her vintage ring. When the police got to her house, they noticed glass on the grass beneath a broken window, a total mess inside and dirty footprints on the carpet. But there were no other signs of a break–in.
The next day, the police arrested Nicole for fraud. Why?

(ANSWERS AT THE LAST PAGE)

“To live is the rarest thing in the world.
Most people exist, that is all.”
— Oscar Wilde

COMICS

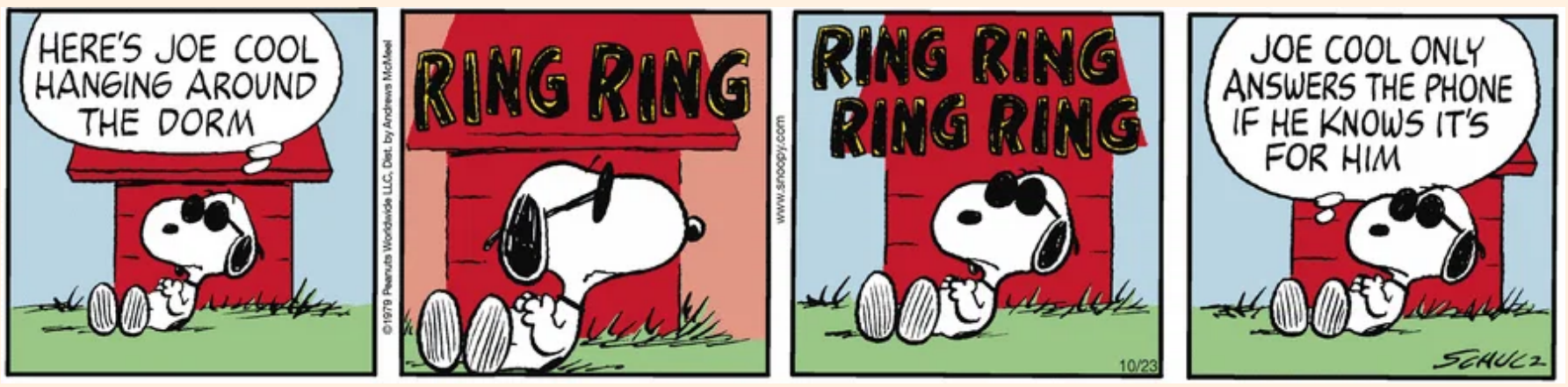
Calvin and Hobbes



Garfield



PEANUTS



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Answers to Riddles:

“Who Am I”: [Footsteps]

“You Be The Detective”: [Upon arriving at the scene, police suspected Nicole staged the break-in because the window glass lay entirely outside, proving it was broken from within.]

Comics Source:
https://www.gocomics.com